



Akis Evangelidis talks

As Nothing co-founder takes over as India president, aiming for 12,000 stores by year-end, he spoke with **Manas Tiwari**

India has always been central to London-based technology Nothing's growth strategy.

After a fabulous 2024, which saw Nothing emerge as the fastest-growing brand in India's smartphone market, registering a +577% year-over-year growth (according to Counterpoint), it is further set to boots its presence in the country. One of the major steps in this direction is the appointment of its co-founder Akis Evangelidis as its President in India. In this expanded position, he will continue to drive Nothing's global vision while leading the strategic direction and growth of the company's operations in India. "Last year was about experimenting, this year, it's about doubling down," Akis told Times Now Tech and Digit in an exclusive interview confirming his new role.

The announcement comes as India's significance in the global smartphone industry continues to grow, fueled by government initiatives and a tech-savvy consumer base. "The Indian consumer is extremely knowledgeable about tech," says Evangelidis. "India is poised to be a major player in the smartphone industry, and we want to be a part of that journey." By the end of 2025, Nothing aims to have its products available in over 12,000 retail stores across the country. It has already expanded its presence in over 9000 retail

stores in the country. Some of its key partners in the country include Croma, Vijay Sales and regional chains in the South like Sangeetha and Poorvika.

It has recently announced that its upcoming Phone (3a) Series will be manufactured locally at its Chennai facility, leveraging India's robust manufacturing ecosystem and investing in the local economy. Separately, Akis confirmed that Nothing has now sold over 7 million products globally and has reached a revenue milestone of \$1 billion.

What worked for Nothing

Four years since its inception, Nothing has emerged as one of the most talked-about brands in the consumer tech space. The London-based startup, co-founded by Carl Pei and Akis Evangelidis, set out to shake up a smartphone industry that had grown stagnant.

When Nothing launched its first product, the Ear (1) wireless earbuds, in 2021, it was met with excitement and curiosity. The brand's promise of design differentiation and a fresh take on consumer technology resonated with tech enthusiasts. "We felt uninspired by the industry," Evangelidis recalls. "Everything looked the same, and there was no grand vision."

What followed was a series of bold moves: backing from industry veterans like Tony Fadell and Steve Huffman, and the release of its first smartphone, the Phone (1), in 2022. "Our goal was to create a design language that was instantly recognisable from two meters away, without the need for a logo," Evangelidis explains. The approach paid off, with over 700,000 units sold. The transition from audio devices to smartphones wasn't easy though. "The smartphone business is an entirely different ballgame," Evangelidis admits. "If you mess up any part of the process — supply chain, product development, marketing, you go bankrupt." However, Nothing's second smartphone, the Phone (2), was a critical success, earning praise for its refined hardware and custom Android-based OS. The launch of the Phone (2a) last year, priced more aggressively for Indian consumers, proved to be a game-changer. "We wanted to test the waters and see if there was an appetite for our unique product experience at different price points," says Evangelidis. "The response was overwhelming and we sold 100,000 units within 24 hours."

Since then the company has seen multiple successes with the launch of its A-series and CMF-branded products. The first CMF Phone 1 sold 100,000 units in just 3 hours. Nothing has also been able to make these products affordable and is trying to build an ecosystem around them.

Strategic shifts & future plans

Nothing is gearing up for the launch of its Phone 3(a) series which now set to be unveiled at the MWC 2025. This is the first time it is adding a Pro model to the lineup with a major focus on the camera. Along with that, another key shift this year has been Nothing's return to Qualcomm chipsets after partnering with MediaTek for the Phone (2a). "The feedback was clear our users wanted Snapdragon processors," Evangelidis notes. "Qualcomm saw the success of our device and worked closely with us to make it happen." *Read the full story here:*

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